

NICHOLLS STATE UNIVERSITY

Request for HSIRB Exemption

1. Name(s) of Principal Investigator(s): Dr. Christopher Castille Phone: 985-449-7015

Other Investigators: None

Faculty Sponsor (If Student Research): N/A (faculty PI) Phone: _____

2. College: CBA (Al Danos) Department: Management and Marketing Phone: 985-449-7015

3. Title of Project or Proposal: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

4. **Description of Project or Proposal (attach additional information as needed):**

- a. Briefly describe the population of human subjects involved (e.g., University students, community members, athletes, homemakers, school children, etc.) **You MUST indicate if this participation is VOLUNTARY or NOT. Subjects must be 18 or older for HSIRB Exemption.**

Two groups, all 18+: (1) MNGT 425 students who choose the research-study assignment (Option A). An equivalent alternative assignment (qualitative responses to each prompt, submitted to the instructor for credit) is available; alt-assignment data are NOT in the main study. No flyer. (2) HR professionals via professional networks; VOLUNTARY. Under-18 excluded. See Attachment A.

- b. Briefly describe your research procedures and techniques of data collection (e.g., interview, questionnaire, test administration, observation of public behavior, etc.). **You MUST include a printed copy of any data collection instrument(s) as well as active link(s) if online or electronic data collection methods are being utilized.**

Electronic informed consent (professional + student forms). Online HR Situational Judgment Test: 27 HR scenarios; optional 1–5 effectiveness ratings per tactic; Skip allowed (no forced responding). Feedback PDF/debrief. ~45–60 min. MNGT 425 Option B qualitative submissions go to the instructor only (not research). Instrument + links: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/> ; consents under [/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/](#). See Attachment A.

- c. Briefly describe the objectives of your research (e.g., what hypotheses you are testing.)

(1) Measure how students rate HR tactic effectiveness in SJT scenarios; (2) measure HR professionals' ratings as an expert benchmark; (3) compare student vs professional ratings; (4) identify most/least effective tactics across HR domains; (5) examine whether evidence-based HR training shifts student ratings toward professional norms (if pre/post used). See Attachment A.

5. a. How will you recruit subjects? **YOU MUST submit VERBATIM COPIES** of all letters, emails, notices, advertisements, etc. and/or all oral presentations to be used to recruit subjects/ participation in the research project (e.g. scripts of direct person-to-person solicitation, telephone solicitation, newspaper solicitation, letters of solicitation, email solicitation, notices of solicitation posted to Facebook or Moodle, etc.).

No flyer. MNGT 425: classroom/LMS announcement of assignment Options A (research SJT) and B (qualitative alt for instructor credit; not research). Professionals: LinkedIn/SHRM/HR networks + consent link. Verbatim announcement in Attachment A / Appendix D.

- b. List all criteria for including subjects.

Age 18+; MNGT 425 students choosing Option A (research assignment); professionals with current/recent HR experience; internet-capable device. See Attachment A.

- c. List all criteria for excluding subjects.

Under 18; unable to complete online assessment; prior participation; students not in MNGT 425 or who chose Option B (alt data not research); no current/recent HR experience (pros).

6. Describe subject benefits and costs:

- a. Indicate what, if any, benefits may accrue to each of the following: (Payment to research subjects for participation in studies is considered a benefit.)

1) The human subjects involved:

Feedback reports; learning about evidence-based HR / SJT; contribution to research; optional aggregated infographic (individuals not identified).

2) Individuals who are not subjects, but who may have similar problems:

Educators and HR trainers may use findings to improve HR education and assessment.

3) Society in general:

Improved understanding of HR situational judgment and evidence-based HR education.

- b. State type, amount, method of disbursement, schedule of payment to be offered, and the effect of withdrawal from participation in the study, if any:

No monetary payment. MNGT 425: Option A (research) or Option B (qualitative alt) earn equivalent assignment credit; Option B data are not in the main study. Pros unpaid. Feedback reports.

- c. Estimated costs to each subject due only to the research participation:

1) Time (i.e., total time commitment for the duration of the project)

Approx. 45–60 minutes for Option A / professional SJT; Option B is a written alt for the instructor.

2) Money

None.

3) Is repeated testing required? Explain:

Not required. Optional pre/post training comparison only if later used under this protocol.

7. BASIS OF REQUEST FOR EXEMPTION - One of the following (A-E) must be checked.

- _____ A. The research will be conducted only in established or commonly accepted educational settings (like classrooms) **AND** it involves normal educational practices such as research on regular and special educational instructional strategies, or research on the effectiveness of, or the comparison among, instructional techniques, curricula or classroom management methods.
- _____ B. It will be conducted using only questionnaire or interview survey methods **AND** the subjects are elected or appointed public officials or candidates for public office.
- _____ C. It is limited to the collection and study of existing data, documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens which are available to the public.

(Request options for exemption continued on next page)

- ☒ D. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained using only the following techniques **AND** the data or information obtained will be recorded in such a manner that subjects cannot be *identified, directly or indirectly*, through identifiers linked with the subjects:

Check the applicable technique(s):

- ☒ 1. The data will be obtained through the use of educational tests (cognitive, diagnostic, aptitude, achievement, etc.), or
- ☐ 2. Data will be obtained by observing the public behavior of subjects, or
- ☒ 3. Data will be obtained using survey or interview procedures, or
- ☐ 4. Data will be obtained from existing documents, records, pathological or diagnostic specimens.

- ☐ E. It is limited to the collection and study of data obtained by:

1. Observing the public behavior of the participants, or
2. Using survey or interview procedures, **AND:**

BOTH OF THE FOLLOWING MUST BE CHECKED IF E-2 IS THE BASIS FOR THE REQUESTED EXEMPTION:

- ☐ i) The information collected about the subjects behavior ***does not involve*** sensitive subjects such as illegal or immoral conduct, drug or alcohol use, sexual behavior, mental illness, or other possibly personally embarrassing subjects **AND**,
- ☐ ii) The information collected about subjects, if it became known to outsiders, could not reasonably be expected to place the subject at risk of civil or criminal liability, or be damaging to the subjects social or financial standing or employability.

8. **Attach copies of current CITI Training certificate(s) for all investigators. Faculty Sponsors of student research must provide a copy of their current CITI Training certificate. Please be sure to select (enroll) and complete the appropriate series of modules based on your area / learner group. URL TO CITI TRAINING: <https://about.citiprogram.org/en/homepage/> There are 5 different learner groups for Nicholls State University:**

Faculty Researchers / Faculty Sponsors – If you are conducting research involving human subjects or if you are the faculty sponsor / supervisor of student research which does NOT involve the areas of biomedical research. **NOTE: Nursing and Allied Health Faculty are required to complete the HIPAA module (not suggested as for all other faculty).**

Student Researchers (Not Nursing/Allied Health): Any research being conducted by a student or student group (either thesis, class project, service/experiential learning, or academic oriented research) where human subjects are involved (surveyed, experimental design, and/or observation).

IRB Members: Any member of the HSIRB Committee at Nicholls State University

CITI attached: Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research / Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors (Basic). Completion 10-May-2024; Expiration 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539. Certificate appended to this PDF.

Nursing and Allied Health Students: Modules in this group include the Basic Social-Behavioral-Educational Modules as well as additional required modules, as required by consensus of the Faculty within the respective College and Department.

Biomedical Data or Specimens/Researchers (Faculty and Students): Any Faculty / Students whose Research involves the use or collection of biomedical data and/or specimens.

NOTE: Depending on the exact protocols used. If additional data is collected by means of a survey from subjects, then the researchers (both faculty, faculty sponsors and students) are required to complete additional modules (Faculty – Faculty Researchers/Research Sponsors; Students – Student Researchers (Not Nursing or Allied Health)).

9. STATEMENT OF RISK:

The undersigned certify that they believe that the conduct of the above described research creates no risk of physical or emotional harm, or social or legal embarrassment to any participating human subject.

Dr. Christopher Castille _____ (Sign/date upon submission)
Signature of Principal Investigator Date

10. FACULTY SPONSOR (if a student is the principal investigator)

N/A — Principal Investigator is faculty _____
Signature of Faculty Sponsor Date

11. RECOMMENDATION OF HSIRB REPRESENTATIVE OR HSIRB CHAIR:

I recommend that the above described research project be exempt from review.

Signature of Chairperson Date HSIRB PROTOCOL NUMBER _____
(Assigned by HSIRB)

NOTE – APPROVE HSIRB Research is valid for a 12 month period of time from the date approved. Approved research can be renewed and extended for a 1 year period at the request of the principle investigator / faculty member – PRIOR to the expiration of an existing HSIRB Protocol Number. Projects can be renewed a maximum of two (2) times. Any faculty wishing to continue a research project beyond year 3 must submit a new request. If approved, a new HSIRB Protocol Number will be issued.

The mailing or distribution of surveys or the collection of data may begin ONLY after this form has received committee approval (ALLOW 10 DAYS FOR PROCESSING) and has been properly filed with the HSIRB Representative or HSIRB Chairperson. It must have signatures of the Principal Investigator(s) or Faculty Sponsor. The Committee may, upon review of this application, deny the request for an exemption. To inquire about approval status, please contact the HSIRB Representative you submitted the application to or the HSIRB Chairperson.

ATTACHMENT A — HSIIRB Exempt Review Request (rev9 2019)

Project: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making

PI: Dr. Christopher Castille | Phone: 985-449-7015 | Email: christopher.castille@nicholls.edu

College: Al Danos College of Business Administration | Dept: Management and Marketing

4a. Population of human subjects

Two groups, all 18+: (1) MNGT 425 students who choose the research-study assignment (Option A). An equivalent alternative assignment (qualitative responses to each prompt, submitted to the instructor for credit) is available; alt-assignment data are NOT in the main study. No flyer. (2) HR professionals via professional networks; VOLUNTARY. Under-18 excluded. See Attachment A.

4b. Research procedures and data collection

Electronic informed consent (professional + student forms). Online HR Situational Judgment Test: 27 HR scenarios; optional 1–5 effectiveness ratings per tactic; Skip allowed (no forced responding). Feedback PDF/debrief. ~45–60 min. MNGT 425 Option B qualitative submissions go to the instructor only (not research). Instrument + links: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/> ; consents under /hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/. See Attachment A.

4c. Objectives of the research

(1) Measure how students rate HR tactic effectiveness in SJT scenarios; (2) measure HR professionals' ratings as an expert benchmark; (3) compare student vs professional ratings; (4) identify most/least effective tactics across HR domains; (5) examine whether evidence-based HR training shifts student ratings toward professional norms (if pre/post used). See Attachment A.

5a. Recruitment (verbatim script)

MNGT 425 — Classroom Assignment Announcement (verbatim; no flyer) Study Title: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making As an assignment in MNGT 425, you are asked to participate in a research study on how students and HR professionals rate the effectiveness of workplace tactics. Option A — Research study assignment: Complete the online HR Situational Judgment Test (27 scenarios). You may rate tactic effectiveness (ratings are optional; you may skip any situation). You will receive a feedback report. After informed consent, your ratings may be used in the research dataset comparing students and HR professionals. Duration: approximately 45–60 minutes. Online; complete at your own pace. You must be 18 or older. Option B — Alternative assignment (not research): If you prefer not to participate in the research study, write a qualitative description of how you would respond to each scenario prompt and submit it to the instructor for course credit. This alternative earns equivalent credit. Your alternative-assignment submission will be used only for grading and will NOT be included in the main research study. Both Option A and Option B satisfy the course assignment. Choosing the alternative does not penalize your grade relative to choosing the study. --- HR professionals — outreach description (verbatim; no flyer): Study Title: HR Situational Judgment Test: Evidence-Based HR Decision-Making Description: You are invited to complete an online HR Situational Judgment Test with 27 HR management scenarios. For each scenario, you may rate the effectiveness of different HR tactics. You will receive a feedback report. Your responses will be used for research on HR education and decision-making. Participation is voluntary. Duration: Approximately 45–60 minutes Mode: Online (complete at your own pace) Requirements: Must be 18 years of age or older; current or recent HR professional experience

5b. Inclusion criteria

- Must be at least 18 years of age - For students: Must be currently enrolled in MNGT 425 (HR Analytics) at Nicholls State University and choose the research-study assignment option (Option A) - For HR professionals: Must have current or recent professional experience in human resources (e.g., HR manager, recruiter, compensation specialist, HR generalist) - Must have access to a computer or device with internet connection - Must be able to complete web-based assessments and download PDF reports

5c. Exclusion criteria

- Under 18 years of age - Unable to complete online assessments due to technical limitations - Previously participated in this study (to avoid duplicate responses) - For students: Not currently enrolled in MNGT 425; or chose the qualitative alternative assignment (Option B) — alternative submissions are not research data - For HR professionals: No current or recent professional experience in human resources

6a–c. Benefits, payment, and costs

Feedback reports; learning about evidence-based HR / SJT; contribution to research; optional aggregated infographic (individuals not identified). | Others: Educators and HR trainers may use findings to improve HR education and assessment. | Society: Improved understanding of HR situational judgment and evidence-based HR education. | Payment: No monetary payment. MNGT 425: Option A (research) or Option B (qualitative alt) earn equivalent assignment credit; Option B data are not in the main study. Pros unpaid. Feedback reports. | Time: Approx. 45–60 minutes for Option A / professional SJT; Option B is a written alt for the instructor. | Money: None. | Repeated testing: Not required. Optional pre/post training comparison only if later used under this protocol.

7. Basis of exemption — Category D (techniques 1 and 3)

This study qualifies for exempt status under Category D (Educational settings, anonymous surveys/interviews) because: 1. The study involves minimal risk to participants (online situational judgment assessment) 2. All data collection is anonymous – students are identified by PRAMS ID numbers; HR professionals by anonymized session IDs 3. The study involves standard educational and business assessment procedures 4. No sensitive topics or vulnerable populations are involved 5. Participants are adults (18+) who can provide informed consent 6. The study does not involve deception, physical procedures, or collection of sensitive information 7. All procedures are standard in educational research settings The study involves only anonymous data collection through online assessments, with no collection of identifying information beyond anonymized identifiers (PRAMS ID numbers for students; session IDs for HR professionals).

8. CITI training

Christopher Castille — Human Subjects Research / Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors (Basic Course). Completion 10-May-2024; Expiration 10-May-2026; Record ID 59381539. Certificate attached.

9. Statement of risk (supporting narrative)

This study involves minimal risk to participants. The primary potential risks are: 1. Psychological discomfort: Feedback may differ from expectations. However, all feedback is provided in a supportive, educational context with emphasis on learning and growth. 2. Time commitment: Research participants invest approximately 45–60 minutes. MNGT 425 students may instead complete the qualitative alternative assignment for equivalent credit. 3. Privacy concerns: While research data are anonymized, there is a minimal risk of data breach. No personally identifying information is stored with research ratings beyond anonymized identifiers. The risks in this study are no greater than those encountered in normal daily activities or routine educational assessments. Mitigation: Risks are mitigated through: 1. Equivalent alternative assignment: MNGT 425 students who prefer not to participate in research may submit a qualitative description of responses to each prompt to the instructor for credit; those submissions are not included in the main study. 2. Comprehensive debriefing / feedback reports for study participants. 3. Anonymization: Research data use anonymized identifiers — no names stored with rating data. 4. Voluntary participation: Research participants can withdraw at any time without penalty. Effectiveness ratings are optional; participants may skip any situation (no forced responding). 5. Secure data storage on password-protected university servers with access limited to the research team.

Active links for IRB review

Interactive instrument (skip/optional ratings): <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/run/> | Professional consent: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/professional-consent/> | Class/student consent: <https://bayoupal.nicholls.edu/hsirb/studies/hr-sjt/student-data-consent/> | Full branded packet: materials/pdf/HSIRB_Application_HR_SJT_Rating_Effectiveness_full_packet.pdf



Completion Date 10-May-2024
Expiration Date 10-May-2026
Record ID 59381539

This is to certify that:

Christopher Castille

Has completed the following CITI Program course:

Not valid for renewal of
certification through CME.

Human Subjects Research
(Curriculum Group)
Faculty Researchers and Research Sponsors
(Course Learner Group)
1 - Basic Course
(Stage)

Under requirements set by:

Nicholls State University

CITI
Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative

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